Charles E. Merriam's 'Political Power' and ***Harold Lasswell***'s 'Politics: Who Gets What, When, How?' made the aspect of power the central theme of politics. The totalitarian regimes in Europe and Asia in the 1920's and 30's and the onset of the Second World War turned the discipline away from its focus on institutions and procedures. Works during this phase focused more on political parties, pressure groups, elites and the basis of electoral choices. This new focus on political behaviour came to be known as 'behaviouralism'. The term was borrowed from 'behaviourism' in psychology. Later, the 1960's saw the emergence of a new trend known as 'Post-Behaviouralism'. It was a reaction against the orthodoxy and dominance of the behavioural methods in the study of politics. The call for the development of this trend was given by ***David Easton***, who ironically, was one of the leading advocates of the behavioural revolution. He claimed that the behavioural method lost touch with reality and hence post-behaviouralism argued that research did not have to be necessarily value free and the emphasis had to be on relevance over precision. Thus, The intellectual revolution resulted in many political scientists attempting to comprehend the sociological, anthropological and psychological aspects of the study of Political Science. They vehemently criticized the traditional methods and its formal and parochial tools of analysis. They pointed out that the political theorists in the past concentrated on state, government, institutions and their formal structures and did not take into consideration the interactions between them and the subjects and failed to examine the political behaviour of humans. Thus, modern political analysis began to rest upon the following four principles:

- the search for comprehensive scope
- the search for realism
- the search for precision
- the search for intellectual order

ACTIVITY

Why is ***Aristotle*** regarded as a great political philosopher? Discuss

Why do we say that both ***Plato*** and ***Aristotle*** had a profound influence on Greek social, political and economic life?

Read more about ***Charles E. Merriam***, ***Woodrow Wilson*** and ***Arthur Bentley*** and find out their important works.

Definition of Political Science

Scholars have defined Political Science in different ways. For ***Garner*** it begins and ends with State. ***Leacock*** and ***Seeley*** see its dealing with government. ***Robson*** and ***Lasswell*** regard it as the study of power and influence. Some scholars define it as the study of political aspects of organized human society. But the latter one instantly enlarges the scope of political science as it tends to include everything. Thus Political Science has been variously defined though for most part of the history the emphasis was placed on state, its institutions, laws and processes. Political behaviour of individuals and groups also became a part of it after the behavioural revolution. The latest addition to this has been the concept of governance.

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